

Pay for love

You may soon need to pay for online dating. The US patent office has awarded dating company eHarmony a patent covering online match-making. Patent number 6,735,568 describes a computer-implemented method for "identifying people who are likely to have a successful relationship". In simple English, this means that eHarmony now owns the patent for 430 psychometric tests which contain questions such as "How much does the word 'dominant' describe you on a list of one through seven?" or "How often do you feel depressed?".



Is love so trivial that your answer to a few questions can tell a computer whether your significant other is right for you or not?

snapshot

The number of US services jobs that will go offshore will increase from 2.2 lakh in 2003 to 17.5 lakh in 2011 to 35 lakh in 2015.

Source: Forrester Research, June 2004

A question of gender

The gender gap extends to segregate mobile users, too. According to the Mobile Media Monitor survey by Enpocket, a US-based mobile marketing services provider, it was found that 58 per cent of all games downloaded to mobiles are by males. Women, on the other hand, account for over half the ringtones

down -

loaded. As expected, over 65 per cent of 3G service users are men. All that money spent, all those statistics, and we're told what we already know...men and women like different things! Let's move on already!

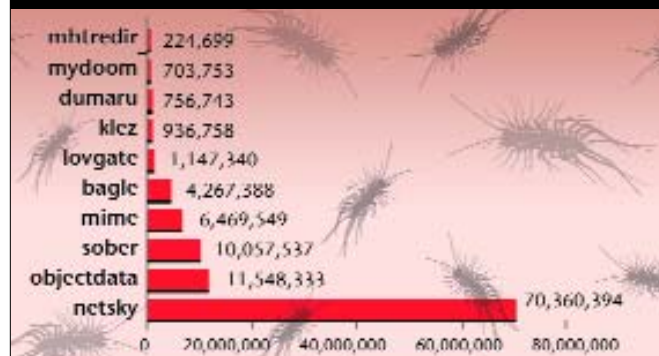


Statattack

May 2004 Spam Category Data



Top Ten Viruses of May 2004 out of 5.7 billion analysed



redalert

W32.Korgo.F

With a threat level rated at 3 by Symantec Security Response, this virus is a variant of the W32.Kargo.E virus. It's designed to exploit the Windows LSASS Buffer Overrun Vulnerability on TCP port 445. Additionally, it's programmed to listen on ports 113, 3067 and other random ports. It does not delete or modify files, but may cause network performance degradation due to the increased traffic it causes. It opens a backdoor, compromising system and data security. The infected PC scans random IPs for a vulnerable computer. On finding one, it opens a random port and attempts to connect to it. After infecting, it connects to one of the pre-defined IRC servers on TCP port 6667. Microsoft describes the problem in Microsoft Security Bulletin MS04-011. An easy way out is to use Windows Update to install available patches.

Opera Favicon Spoof

There's a vulnerability in all Opera browsers below v7.51, by which visitors to a fake Web site can be made to believe they're at another site. This is because Opera does not check the width of the Favourites icon. A carefully designed icon can cover the address bar with custom information, confusing and perhaps misleading users.

snapshot

19.5%: India's IT spending growth in 2004

Source: Reuters